DEKALB COUNTY $155M HOUSING INVESTMENT BOND (RESOLUTION 2026-1044)

DeKalb Homeowner & Buyer Readiness Guide: BrighterHome ($30K) & HomeStart ($20K)

Verified program mechanics, paperwork checklist for legacy homeowners, and pre-purchase protection for DeKalb homebuyers and real estate agents.

Foresight Home Inspections, LLC
Christopher Boykin, CMI #MICB-1082
2-Inspector Team | $35,000 Combined Protection
678-480-2110 | fhinspectionsatl.com

Consumer Protection Notice for DeKalb Seniors & Veterans: Do NOT pay any private company or contractor upfront for a "BrighterHome qualification inspection." Under Decide DeKalb and DeKalb County program rules, initial intake qualification is 100% paperwork-based. Once your deed, residency, tax, and income documents are approved, Decide DeKalb assigns a pre-qualified program inspector/contractor to evaluate your home and write the official scope of work at **$0 cost to you**.

1. DeKalb BrighterHome Rehab Program

Up to $30,000 Forgivable

Administered by **Decide DeKalb Development Authority** (decidedekalb.com). Forgivable loan (100% forgiven after 10 years of continued primary occupancy) for critical roof, HVAC, electrical, plumbing, and accessibility repairs.

Paperwork to Gather Before the Portal Opens:

- ✓ **10+ Years Primary Residency & Clear Title:** Recorded warranty deed in your name (minimum 10 consecutive years owner-occupied; priority for 15+ years). Resolve any deceased spouse or heir-property probate clouds now.
- ✓ **Household Income ≤ 80% AMI:** Tax returns, W-2s, Social Security, or pension award letters showing combined household income at or below 80% Area Median Income (priority for <60% AMI, seniors 62+, veterans, and disabled residents).
- ✓ **Current DeKalb Property Taxes & Mortgage:** Verification from the DeKalb Tax Commissioner that property taxes and any mortgage are paid current.
- ✓ **Active Homeowner's Insurance Declaration Page:** Programs require active hazard insurance coverage in force on the property.
- ✓ **No Prior SPHRP Grant in Past 10 Years:** Confirm you have not received DeKalb Special Purpose Home Repair ($14K CDBG) funds within the last 10 years.

2. DeKalb HomeStart & Retail Inspections

Up to $20,000 Buyer DPA

Also funded by the $155M Housing Bond, **DeKalb HomeStart** provides up to **$20,000** (with enhanced tiers for DeKalb public servants, teachers, and first responders) in 0%-interest, 10-year forgivable down payment and closing cost assistance.

When You SHOULD Book Foresight ($345+):

- ✓ **DeKalb HomeStart Homebuyers ($345+):** Unlike rehab grants, buyers under a Purchase Agreement must hire their own independent inspector during due diligence. Every inspection deploys **2 inspectors on-site** with a calibrated infrared thermal camera and $35,000 combined protection ($10K Elite Master Warranty + $25K InterNACHI Honor Guarantee).
- ✓ **Legacy Owners Deciding to Sell Instead ($345+):** Over the 80% AMI income cap, or do not want a **10-year residency lien** on your equity? Book a Pre-Listing Seller Inspection with regional contractor cost data before listing.
- ✓ **DeKalb Low-Flow Water Certificate & Annual Checkups:** Fast turnaround on DeKalb County Low-Flow Plumbing Certificates, Sewer Scopes, Radon, and 11-Month Warranty Inspections.

DeKalb County Housing Assistance Comparison Matrix (2026–2027)

Program Name & Administrator	Max Benefit & Terms	Who Qualifies	How the Home Inspection Works
DeKalb BrighterHome Decide DeKalb (decidedekalb.com)	**Up to $30,000** 0% interest, forgiven after 10-yr primary residency	10+ yr DeKalb homeowners at ≤80% AMI (priority: <60% AMI, 62+, veterans, disabled, 15+ yr owners)	**$0 to Homeowner:** Decide DeKalb assigns a pre-qualified bench contractor/inspector *after* your paper application is approved.
Special Purpose Home Repair (SPHRP) DeKalb Community Development (404-371-2727)	**Up to $14,000** Deferred forgivable loan, forgiven after 5-yr residency	Seniors 62+ or disabled adults 21+ at ≤60% AMI (12+ months on title; excludes City of Atlanta limits)	**$0 to Homeowner:** County Housing Rehabilitation Specialist performs the on-site work write-up *after* intake approval.
DeKalb HomeStart (Buyers) Decide DeKalb (decidedekalb.com)	**Up to $20,000+** 0% silent second for down payment & closing costs (10-yr forgiveness)	Eligible first-time buyers & DeKalb public servants purchasing a home anywhere in DeKalb County	**Buyer Hires Private Inspector ($345+):** Book Foresight Home Inspections during your due diligence window for a 2-inspector evaluation & Georgia Repair Amendment documentation.

Buying with DeKalb HomeStart, Listing a DeKalb Home, or Need a DeKalb Low-Flow Certificate?
Same-Day Interactive Digital Reports | 2-Inspector Team | Calibrated Infrared Thermal Camera Included | $35,000 Combined Protection

Book Online at fhinspectionsatl.com →

Educational Resource Disclosure: Published by Foresight Home Inspections, LLC (Christopher Boykin, CMI #MICB-1082 | Phone: 678-480-2110 | Email: inspect@foresightcmi.com) as a free community and real estate educational service. Foresight Home Inspections, LLC is an independent inspection firm and is not a government eligibility intake office. Program guidelines and portal dates are governed by DeKalb County Government (dekalbcountyga.gov) and the Decide DeKalb Development Authority (decidedekalb.com, 678-915-6800).